



Learn



Practice

Chemical Bonding: Hybridisation and Spatial Geometry: Construction

Contents and concept route



Sections+

Electron-Domain Counting and Molecular Shape Geometry

Subject: Chemistry

Topic: Chemical Bonding and Molecular Structure

Concept: Electron-Domain Counting and Molecular Shape Geometry

Concept difficulty: Medium concept

1 Compare full local inventories, not only the common three sigma bonds.

Medium concept

Section 1 of 10

Next →

Conditions for this construction

- Lewis structures
- VSEPR repulsion

Why this section matters for the question set

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1 Inventory bonds and central lone pairs separately.

Why valid: The givens supply three bonds at each centre but different lone-pair counts.

Result: BF₃: 3+0=3 domains; NH₃: 3+1=4.

2 The step the hard question turns on Apply the bounded introductory domain models.

Why valid: The local total, rather than bonds alone, selects the model arrangement.

Result: BF₃: planar/sp²; NH₃: tetrahedral domains/sp³-like.

3 Name shape using bonded nuclei only.

Why valid: The N lone-pair domain has no bonded nucleus.

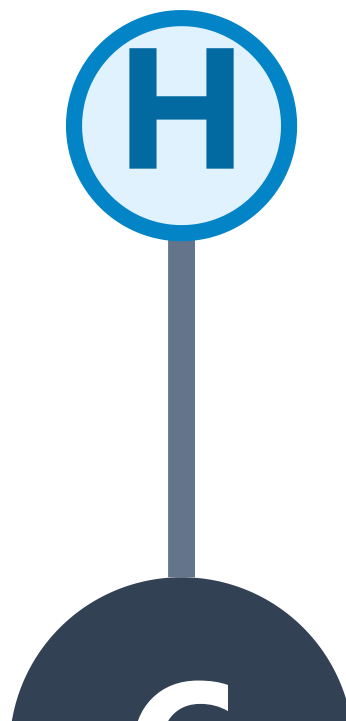
Result: BF₃ is trigonal planar; NH₃ is trigonal pyramidal.

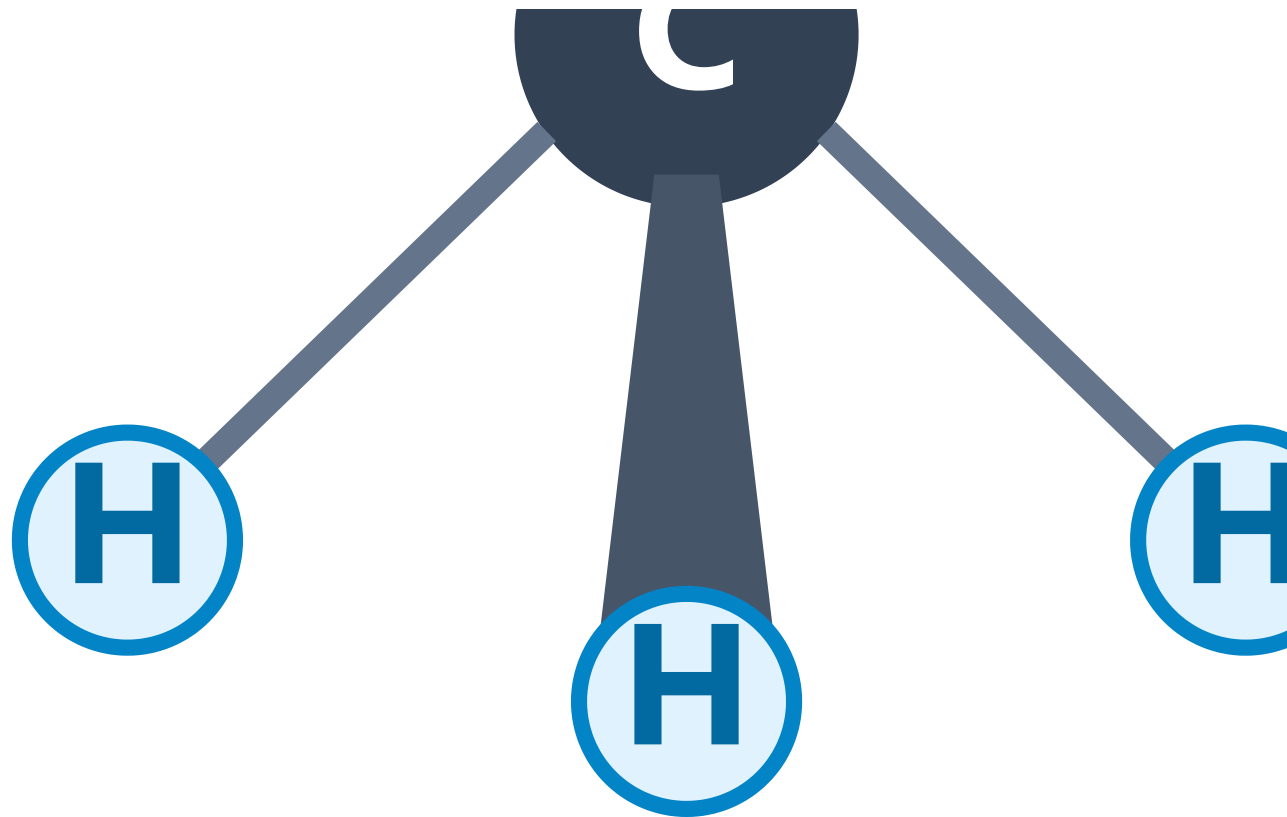
4 Compare NH₃ with H₂O.

Why valid: Three-bond/one-pair and two-bond/two-pair inventories both total four.

Result: The same domain total can give different bonded-nucleus shapes.

CH₄ (0 Lone Pairs)





Tetrahedral

Bond Angle: 109.5°

Domain geom = Shape

CH₄ tetrahedral (0 LP)

Stage 1 of 3

Compare steric number 4 across CH₄, NH₃, and H₂O showing lone pair effect on shape.

The key step

CH₄, NH₃, H₂O have four introductory domains but tetrahedral, pyramidal and bent nuclear shapes respectively.

Worked explanation

Count local domains and bonded nuclei separately in BF₃, NH₃ and H₂O.

Follow the operation, its justification and its result.

1. A central lone pair adds a domain even though it adds no bonded nucleus.
2. Totals 3,4,4; bonded nuclei 3,3,2.
3. BF₃ has three B domains; NH₃ has three bonds plus one N lone pair. Introductory sp²/planar versus sp³-like domain/pyramidal shape follows the local model.

Result

Totals 3,4,4; bonded nuclei 3,3,2.

Check

Changed check: H₂O and NH₃ have different numbers of bonds but the same four-domain total.

Mistake clinic • diagnose and repair

+

1-2-3 QUICK CHECK

1 • CHECK

Changed check: H₂O and NH₃ have different numbers of bonds but the same four-domain total.

2 • APPLY

Compare a four-bond centre with a two-bond/two-lone-pair centre.

3 • CONNECT

A central lone pair adds a domain even though it adds no bonded nucleus.

2 Test whether three sigma bonds are sufficient for the proposed label.

Medium concept

Section 2 of 10

← Previous

Next →

Why this section matters for the question set

+

1 Hold the claimed three-sigma condition fixed.

Why valid: Both supplied centres satisfy it, so an omitted lone-pair condition can test the implication.

Result: BF₃ and NH₃ both have three sigma bonds.

2 The step the hard question turns on Use nitrogen as the counterexample.

Why valid: NH₃ also has one central lone pair; its local total is four.

Result: Three sigma bonds alone do not imply three domains/sp².

3 Replace the claim with a conditional local rule.

Why valid: Within localized introductory classification, bonds plus central lone pairs determine the domain

total.

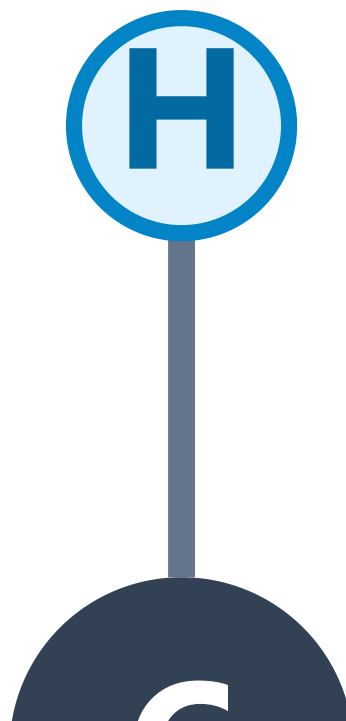
Result: Use the full inventory: three domains -> sp² model; four -> sp³-like model.

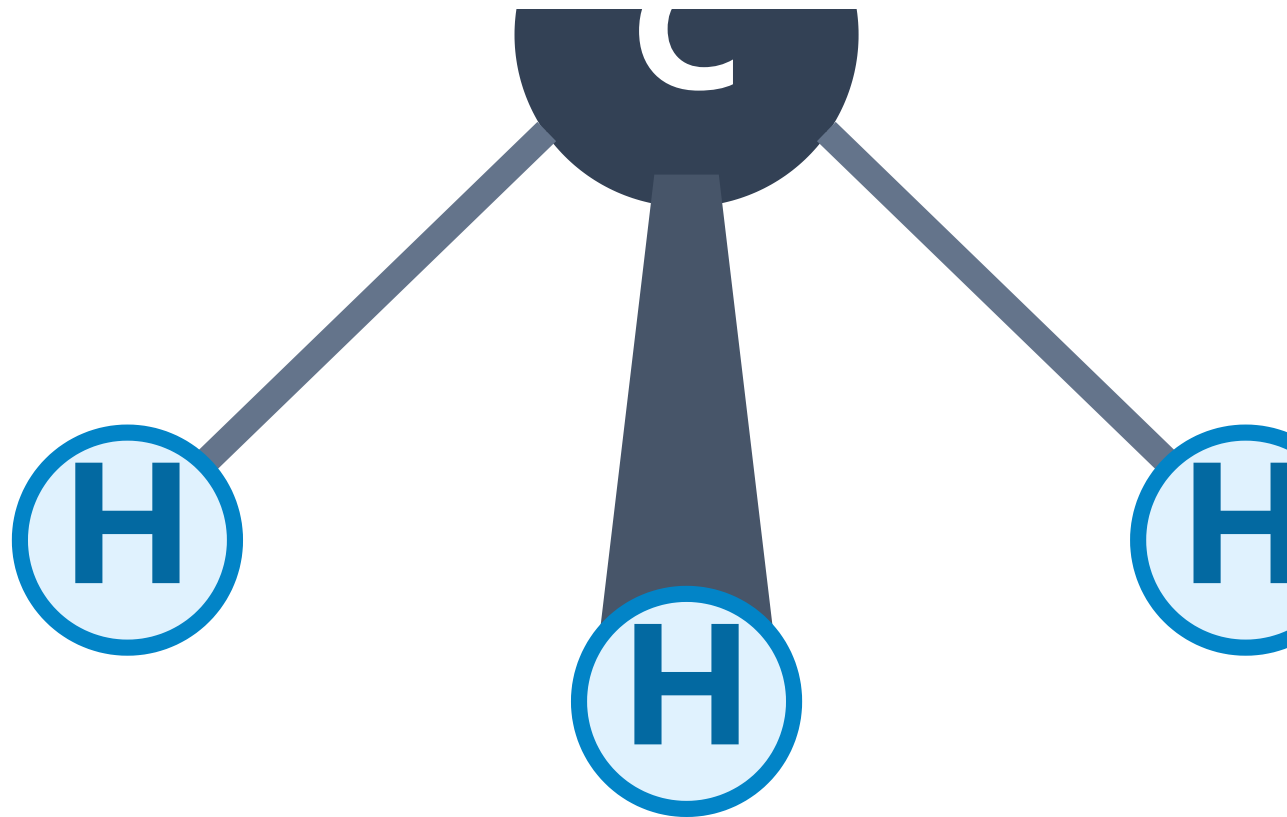
4 Separate shape observations from a unique orbital basis.

Why valid: Nuclear geometry constrains a description but does not measure hybrid coefficients.

Result: The counterexample rejects the bond-only rule without proving unique physical hybrid orbitals.

CH₄ (0 Lone Pairs)





Tetrahedral

Bond Angle: 109.5°

Domain geom = Shape

CH₄ tetrahedral (0 LP)

Stage 1 of 3

Compare steric number 4 across CH₄, NH₃, and H₂O showing lone pair effect on shape.

Worked explanation

Would a three-bond nitrogen with a lone pair and a three-bond boron without one require identical domain inventories? Explain.

Follow the operation, its justification and its result.

1. A counterexample must hold the claimed condition while changing an omitted relevant condition.

2. No: four versus three. Keeping the answer identical despite the changed lone-pair condition suggests the misconception.
3. NH3 falsifies three-sigma-implies-sp2: its local lone pair makes four domains. Geometry constrains a model but does not uniquely prove a hybrid basis.

Result

No: four versus three. Keeping the answer identical despite the changed lone-pair condition suggests the misconception.

Check

Changed check: BF3 and NH3 share three bonds but differ in local lone pairs; the proposed rule predicts the same result incorrectly.

Mistake clinic • diagnose and repair



1-2-3 QUICK CHECK

1 • CHECK

Changed check: BF3 and NH3 share three bonds but differ in local lone pairs; the proposed rule predicts the same result incorrectly.

2 • APPLY

Repair the rule with an explicit applicability condition.

3 • CONNECT

A counterexample must hold the claimed condition while changing an omitted relevant condition.

3 Separate number of bonding directions from bond identity or strength.

Medium concept

Section 3 of 10

← Previous

Next →

Why this section matters for the question set

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1 Recount carbon neighbours after H-to-F substitution.

Why valid: CH3F has three H and one F directly attached to C.

Result: Four carbon bonding directions.

2 The step the hard question turns on Apply the same local four-domain allocation.

Why valid: Changing substituent identity does not itself create a new neighbour or lone pair at C.

Result: Introductory sp^3 carbon model.

3 State what the count leaves open.

Why valid: Bond lengths, polarity and exact angles require information beyond neighbour counting.

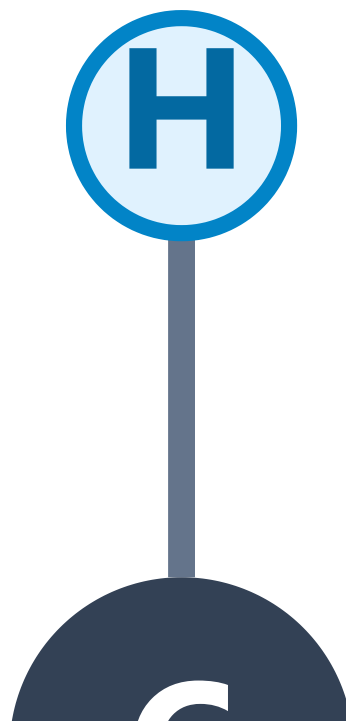
Result: No equality of C-H and C-F properties is inferred.

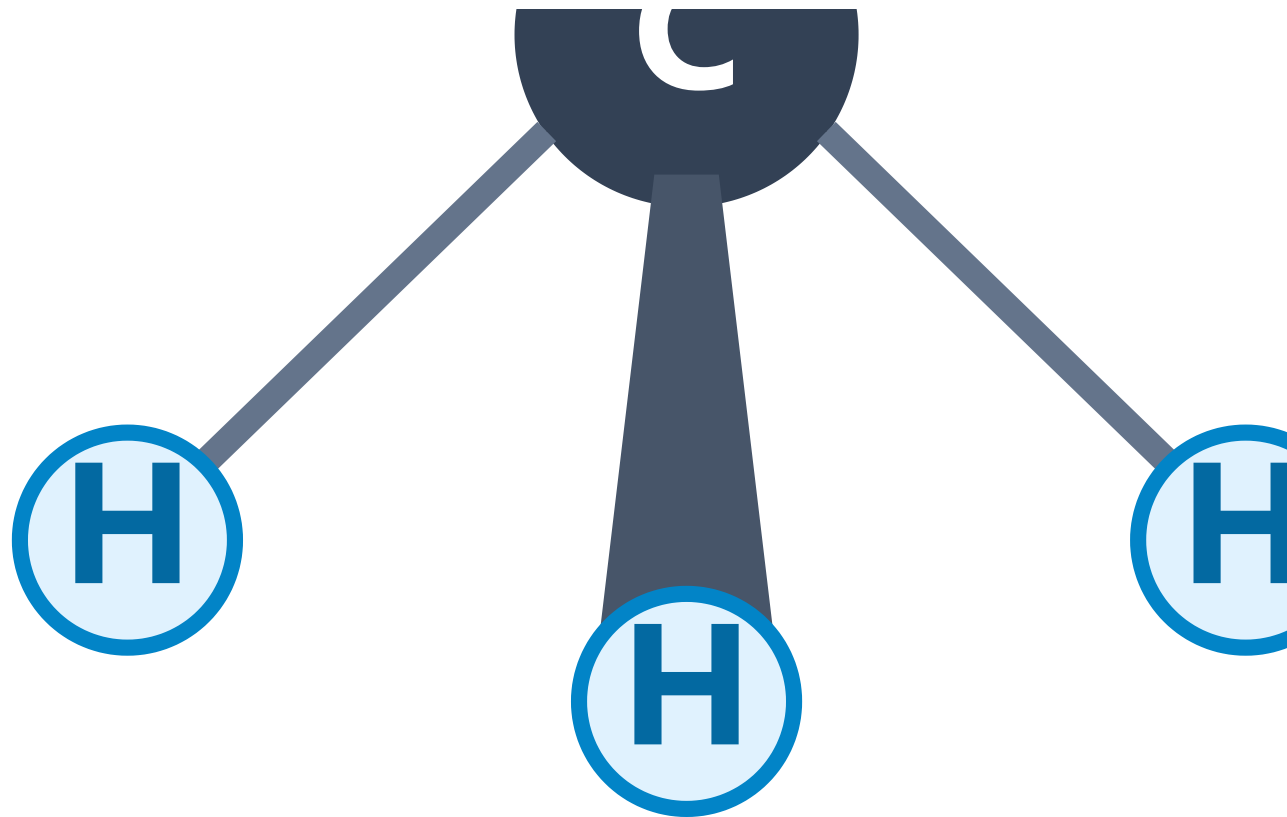
4 Test CH₂F₂ as a changed inventory.

Why valid: Two H and two F are still four neighbours.

Result: Four domains remain; electronegativity is not an extra domain.

CH₄ (0 Lone Pairs)





Tetrahedral

Bond Angle: 109.5°

Domain geom = Shape

CH₄ tetrahedral (0 LP)

Stage 1 of 3

Compare steric number 4 across CH₄, NH₃, and H₂O showing lone pair effect on shape.

Worked explanation

Count carbon domains in CH₄, CH₃F and CH₂F₂. Does each F add an extra domain beyond its C-F direction?

Follow the operation, its justification and its result.

1. Replacing a substituent changes chemical environment without automatically changing connectivity count.

2. All four; no.
3. CH₃F carbon has four bonding directions and introductory sp³ accounting. The count alone establishes neither bond lengths nor their detailed causes.

Result

All four; no.

Check

Changed check: CH₂F₂ still has four central bonding directions; electronegativity is not an extra domain.

Mistake clinic • diagnose and repair



1-2-3 QUICK CHECK

1 • CHECK

Changed check: CH₂F₂ still has four central bonding directions; electronegativity is not an extra domain.

2 • APPLY

Classify carbon in CHCl₃ without assigning an exact bond angle.

3 • CONNECT

Replacing a substituent changes chemical environment without automatically changing connectivity count.

4 Count local domains and bonded nuclei at two different centres.

Medium concept

Section 4 of 10

← Previous

Next →

Why this section matters for the question set

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1 Make atom-local inventories in CH₃NH₂.

Why valid: C has four single bonds; N has three single bonds and one lone pair.

Result: C: 4+0; N: 3+1; both total four domains.

2 The step the hard question turns on Assign the localized introductory domain models.

Why valid: Each four-domain centre can use sp³-like accounting under the stated local model.

Result: Four model directions at each centre.

3 Count nuclei for the separate shape descriptions.

Why valid: C has four bonded neighbours while N has three; a lone pair is not an atomic vertex.

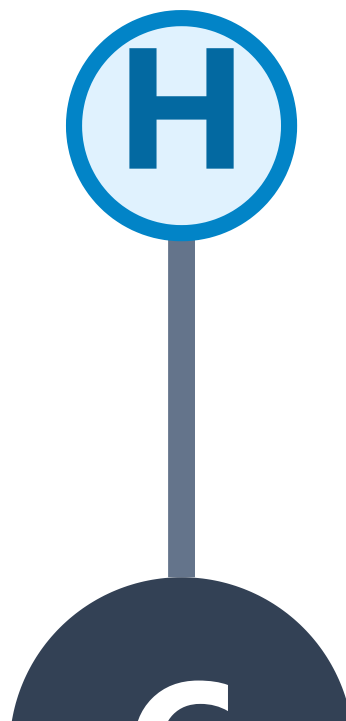
Result: Tetrahedral C nuclear arrangement; pyramidal N arrangement.

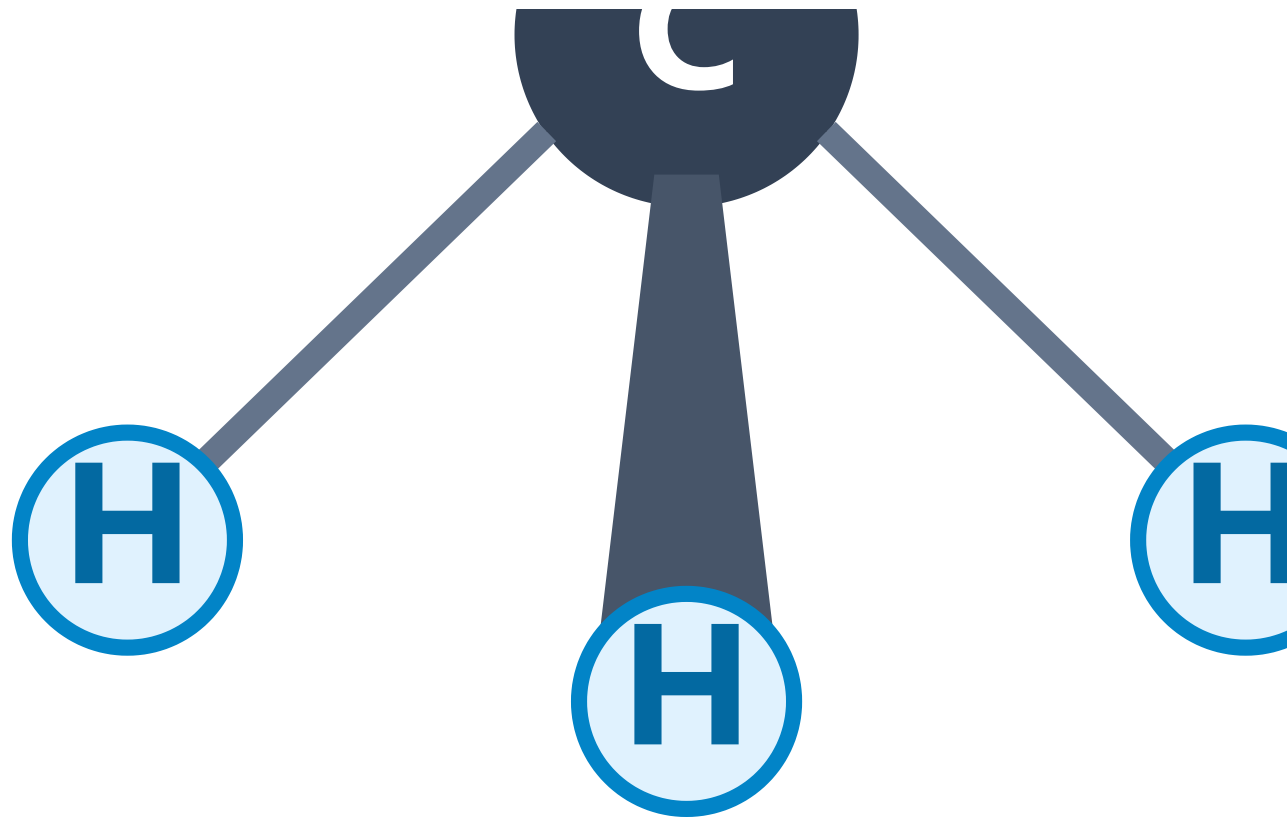
4 Replace an N-H bond with an N-CH₃ bond in a neutral amine comparison.

Why valid: The N inventory stays three bonds plus one lone pair.

Result: Local N count and pyramidal introductory description persist; exact angle is unresolved.

CH₄ (0 Lone Pairs)





Tetrahedral

Bond Angle: 109.5°

Domain geom = Shape

CH₄ tetrahedral (0 LP)

Stage 1 of 3

Compare steric number 4 across CH₄, NH₃, and H₂O showing lone pair effect on shape.

Worked explanation

Compare local N inventory with carbon inventory in CH₃NH₂. Which centre includes a lone-pair direction?

Follow the operation, its justification and its result.

1. A lone pair contributes to electron-domain geometry but is excluded from molecular-shape naming.

2. N does; C does not. Using one atom-global shape for both reveals locality confusion.
3. Methylamine C has four bonded directions; N has three bonded directions and one lone pair. Introductory tetrahedral C and pyramidal N nuclear arrangements differ despite four-domain totals.

Result

N does; C does not. Using one atom-global shape for both reveals locality confusion.

Check

Changed check: replacing N-H with N-CH₃ preserves the local three-bond-plus-lone-pair N inventory in the neutral localized amine model.

Mistake clinic • diagnose and repair

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1-2-3 QUICK CHECK

1 • CHECK

Changed check: replacing N-H with N-CH₃ preserves the local three-bond-plus-lone-pair N inventory in the neutral localized amine model.

2 • APPLY

Describe a neutral secondary amine N without predicting an exact experimental angle.

3 • CONNECT

A lone pair contributes to electron-domain geometry but is excluded from molecular-shape naming.

5 Test whether domain geometry and nuclear shape are interchangeable.

Medium concept

Section 5 of 10

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Next →

Why this section matters for the question set

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1 Hold the four-domain total fixed across three cases.

Why valid: CH₄, NH₃ and H₂O have respective bond/pair inventories 4/0, 3/1 and 2/2.

Result: All have four introductory domains.

2 The step the hard question turns on Use all domains for domain geometry.

Why valid: Bonding and lone-pair entries occupy the domain-model directions.

Result: Tetrahedral electron-domain arrangement in all three.

3 Use bonded nuclei for molecular shape.

Why valid: Removing LP entries from the shape name changes the number of atomic vertices.

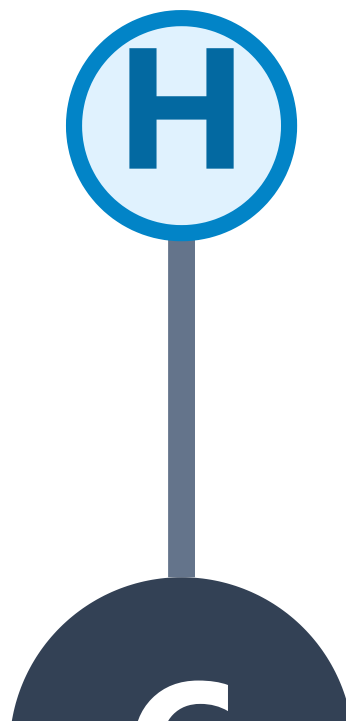
Result: CH₄ tetrahedral; NH₃ pyramidal; H₂O bent.

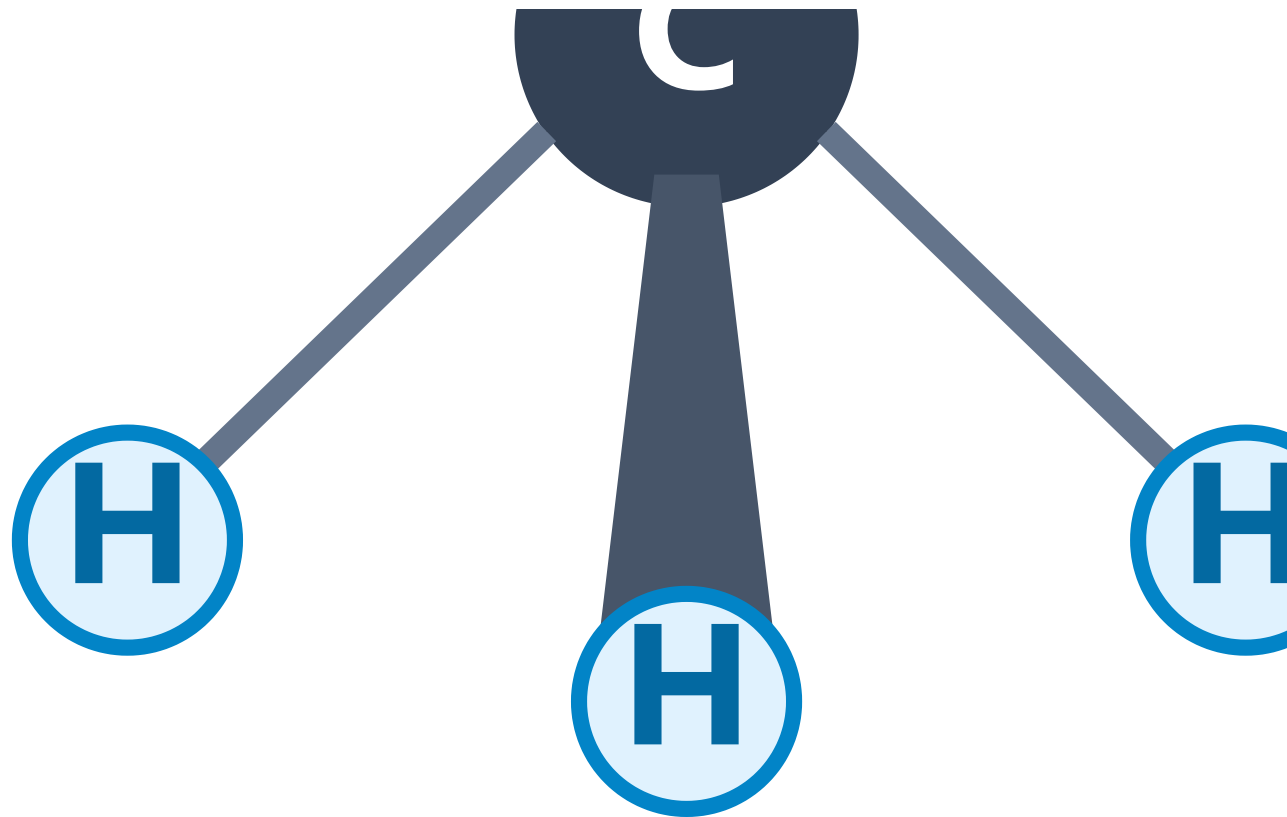
4 State the condition for the two names to coincide.

Why valid: When there is no central lone pair every domain direction terminates at a bonded nucleus.

Result: The student claim holds for the no-lone-pair case, not universally.

CH₄ (0 Lone Pairs)





Tetrahedral

Bond Angle: 109.5°

Domain geom = Shape

CH₄ tetrahedral (0 LP)

Stage 1 of 3

Compare steric number 4 across CH₄, NH₃, and H₂O showing lone pair effect on shape.

Worked explanation

For four-domain inventories with 4,3,2 bonded atoms, give the atom-only shape and explain omitted slots.

Follow the operation, its justification and its result.

1. A lone-pair domain has no bonded nucleus to include in molecular-shape naming.

2. Tetrahedral, pyramidal, bent; omitted slots are lone pairs. Repeating tetrahedral for all atom-only shapes exposes the conflation.
3. CH₄, NH₃, H₂O have four introductory domains but tetrahedral, pyramidal and bent nuclear shapes respectively.

Result

Tetrahedral, pyramidal, bent; omitted slots are lone pairs. Repeating tetrahedral for all atom-only shapes exposes the conflation.

Check

Changed check: a four-bond/no-lone-pair centre cannot be assigned the same atom-only shape as a two-bond/two-lone-pair centre.

Mistake clinic • diagnose and repair



1-2-3 QUICK CHECK

1 • CHECK

Changed check: a four-bond/no-lone-pair centre cannot be assigned the same atom-only shape as a two-bond/two-lone-pair centre.

2 • APPLY

Sketch the domain and atom-only inventories separately for H₂O.

3 • CONNECT

A lone-pair domain has no bonded nucleus to include in molecular-shape naming.

Question-specific diagnosis and repair



Now you do one

Given OF₂ with two O-F bonds and two O lone pairs, classify the domain arrangement and bonded-nucleus shape at O. Explain why terminal-F lone pairs are excluded.

Practice this concept in Core2

Q1

Q5

Q6

Q8

Q10

Sections+

Multiple Bonds, Unhybridised Orbitals, and Spatial Coordination

Subject: Chemistry**Topic:** Chemical Bonding and Molecular Structure**Concept:** Multiple Bonds, Unhybridised Orbitals, and Spatial Coordination**Concept difficulty:** Medium concept**1**

Conserve carbon orbitals while separating domains from sigma/pi components.

Medium concept

Section 6 of 10

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Conditions for this construction

- Lewis structures
- VSEPR electron-domain counting

Why this section matters for the question set

+

1 Count C neighbours in HCHO.

Why valid: Two H and one O are three connections; bond multiplicity is a separate inventory.

Result: Three domains; no C lone pair.

2 The step the hard question turns on Allocate the four carbon valence functions.

Why valid: One 2s plus two 2p form three sp² hybrids, leaving the third 2p unused in that mixing.

Result: Three sigma-direction hybrids plus one residual p.

3 Resolve the C=O bond components.

Why valid: A localized double-bond account has one axial sigma and one lateral pi component.

Result: C=O: one sigma + one pi; residual C p supplies the pi role.

4 Close the basis ledger using an sp comparison.

Why valid: sp gives two hybrids and two residual p functions from the same four inputs.

Result: Both allocations total four; no p function is spent twice.

Stage 1: Lewis Domain Co

$:\ddot{\text{O}} = \text{C} = \ddot{\text{O}}:$ → 2 Electron Do

Double bond = 1 domain; Linea

Lewis domain count

Stage 1 of 4

Model linear sp hybridisation and orthogonal unhybridised p orbital overlap in CO₂.

The key step

CO₂ carbon: two domains/sp, two sigma components and two pi components. A localized VB drawing is useful accounting, not a unique experimentally compulsory terminal-O orbital-plane picture.

Worked explanation

Inventory sp² carbon and sp carbon; can a p orbital used in a hybrid also be counted as a separate residual p?

Follow the operation, its justification and its result.

1. Three sigma directions do not consume the remaining perpendicular p orbital.
2. No double use. Totals remain four in both cases.
3. HCHO carbon has three-domain sp² accounting, three sp² sigma directions and one unhybridised p orbital; C=O has one sigma plus one pi.

Result

No double use. Totals remain four in both cases.

Check

Changed check: for an sp carbon, two hybrids plus two residual p orbitals still total four basis functions.

Mistake clinic • diagnose and repair

+

1-2-3 QUICK CHECK

1 • CHECK

Changed check: for an sp carbon, two hybrids plus two residual p orbitals still total four basis functions.

2 • APPLY

Inventory HCN carbon without copying the formaldehyde count.

3 • CONNECT

Three sigma directions do not consume the remaining perpendicular p orbital.

2 Construct the relation between the molecular plane and the pi orbitals.

Medium concept

Section 7 of 10

← Previous

Next →

Why this section matters for the question set

+

1 Build the two local carbon sigma frames.

Why valid: Each ethene carbon has three sigma directions and one remaining p function in sp^2 accounting.

Result: Two in-plane three-direction frames; one perpendicular p at each C.

2 The step the hard question turns on Align the p functions relative to the molecular plane.

Why valid: A residual p is perpendicular to its carbon sigma plane.

Result: Parallel perpendicular p directions in planar ethene.

3 Draw both axial and lateral overlap.

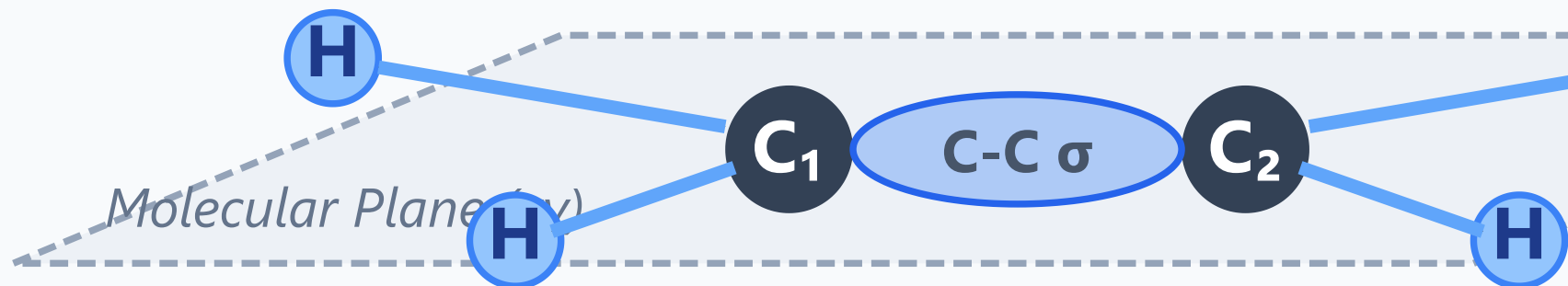
Why valid: The C-C sigma component is axial; lateral p overlap lies above and below the plane.

Result: A sigma framework plus a pi component with a node in the molecular plane.

4 Compare rigid rotation with relative CH_2 -group rotation.

Why valid: Only the latter changes relative p alignment.

Result: Whole-picture rotation preserves overlap geometry; relative twisting can reduce pi alignment.



In-plane σ -framework: 5 σ bonds (1 C-C, 4 C-H) lie in the n

In-plane sp² sigma framework

Stage 1 of 2

Model planar sigma backbone and perpendicular pi overlap in ethene.

Worked explanation

Rotate the whole ethene picture, then rotate only one CH₂ group. Which operation changes relative p alignment?

Follow the operation, its justification and its result.

1. Three sigma directions lie in each sp^2 carbon plane; residual p is perpendicular to that plane.
2. Only the relative-group rotation changes alignment. A whole-page-orientation answer exposes a representation error.
3. Ethene has a coplanar sigma framework; the two residual p directions are parallel and perpendicular to it in the introductory model.

Result

Only the relative-group rotation changes alignment. A whole-page-orientation answer exposes a representation error.

Check

Changed check: rotate one CH_2 group while preserving C-C connectivity; ask which overlap is sensitive to the relative orientation.

Mistake clinic · diagnose and repair

+

1-2-3 QUICK CHECK

1 · CHECK

Changed check: rotate one CH₂ group while preserving C-C connectivity; ask which overlap is sensitive to the relative orientation.

2 • APPLY

Sketch a qualitative twisted ethene comparison without predicting a numerical barrier.

3 • CONNECT

Three sigma directions lie in each sp² carbon plane; residual p is perpendicular to that plane.

3

The central carbon inventory must support two directions and two pi components.

Medium concept

Section 8 of 10

← Previous

Next →

Why this section matters for the question set

+

1 Count two O neighbours at CO₂ carbon.

Why valid: Each C=O multiple bond contributes one local direction.

Result: Two carbon domains; linear introductory framework.

2 The step the hard question turns on Allocate carbon orbitals without duplication.

Why valid: One 2s plus one 2p yields two sp hybrids; two p directions remain perpendicular.

Result: Two sigma directions and two residual C p functions.

3 Account for each localized C=O component.

Why valid: Two double bonds require two sigma and two pi components in this bookkeeping model.

Result: Two sigma + two pi; all four carbon functions have declared roles.

4 Bound the inference about terminal oxygen.

Why valid: A localized basis drawing is one representation of the electronic description; carbon counting does not uniquely measure an oxygen basis.

Result: Linear carbon accounting is consistent; a unique observed O orbital-plane picture is not established.

Stage 1: Lewis Domain Co

$:\ddot{\text{O}} = \text{C} = \ddot{\text{O}}:$ → 2 Electron Do

Double bond = 1 domain; Linea

Lewis domain count

Stage 1 of 4

Model linear sp hybridisation and orthogonal unhybridised p orbital overlap in CO₂.

Worked explanation

Give carbon orbital inventory for CO₂ and HCN. Does a localized drawing uniquely measure the oxygen orbital basis?

Follow the operation, its justification and its result.

1. sp accounting leaves two mutually perpendicular p directions.
2. Both carbon inventories close at four. No unique O basis follows from the drawing alone.
3. CO₂ carbon: two domains/sp, two sigma components and two pi components. A localized VB drawing is useful accounting, not a unique experimentally compulsory terminal-O orbital-plane picture.

Result

Both carbon inventories close at four. No unique O basis follows from the drawing alone.

Check

Changed check: HCN carbon also has two sigma directions and two residual p directions although its neighbours differ.

Mistake clinic · diagnose and repair

+

1-2-3 QUICK CHECK

1 • CHECK

Changed check: HCN carbon also has two sigma directions and two residual p directions although its neighbours differ.

2 • APPLY

State what CO₂ geometry supports and what it cannot uniquely prove.

3 • CONNECT

sp accounting leaves two mutually perpendicular p directions.

4 Keep local inventories separate from the triple-bond component inventory.

Medium concept

Section 9 of 10

← Previous

Next →

Why this section matters for the question set

+

1 Inventory carbon and nitrogen separately in HCN.

Why valid: C has H and N neighbours; N has one C neighbour plus one lone pair.

Result: C: two domains; N: two domains.

2 The step the hard question turns on Allocate each local four-function valence basis.

Why valid: Two sp hybrids leave two perpendicular p functions at each second-period centre.

Result: Introductory sp at C and N.

3 Count triple-bond components without adding local directions.

Why valid: Axial overlap gives one sigma; the two residual p pairs give two pi components.

Result: C-N: one sigma + two pi; C-H adds one sigma.

4 Close the ten-valence-electron inventory.

Why valid: H+C+N contributes $1+4+5=10$; four shared pairs and one N lone pair use five pairs.

Result: Eight bonding electrons + two lone-pair electrons = ten.

Stage 1: Lewis Domain Co

:Ö = C = Ö: → 2 Electron Do

Double bond = 1 domain; Linea

Lewis domain count

Stage 1 of 4

Model linear sp hybridisation and orthogonal unhybridised p orbital overlap in CO₂.

Worked explanation

Compare domain counts at C and N with the total number of shared pairs in HCN.

Follow the operation, its justification and its result.

1. One bonded neighbour supplies one direction even when three bond components are present.
2. Both local domain counts are two; four shared pairs plus N lone pair close the ten-electron ledger.
3. HCN carbon and nitrogen have introductory sp local accounting; C-N contains one sigma and two pi components.

Result

Both local domain counts are two; four shared pairs plus N lone pair close the ten-electron ledger.

Check

Changed check: total valence electrons HCN = $1+4+5 = 10$; the three shared pairs and N lone pair plus C-H pair use all ten.

1-2-3 QUICK CHECK

1 • CHECK

Changed check: total valence electrons HCN = $1+4+5 = 10$; the three shared pairs and N lone pair plus C-H pair use all ten.

2 • APPLY

Compare HCN and CO₂ local carbon inventories.

3 • CONNECT

One bonded neighbour supplies one direction even when three bond components are present.

5 Avoid spending a carbon basis function twice.

Medium concept

Section 10 of 10

← Previous

Why this section matters for the question set

+

1 Start from four carbon valence-basis functions.

Why valid: The second-period basis is one 2s plus three 2p.

Result: Four inputs; three sigma directions and one pi role required.

2 The step the hard question turns on Mix only the functions assigned to sigma directions.

Why valid: One s plus two p makes three in-plane sp^2 hybrids.

Result: Three hybrids; one p remains outside the mixing.

3 Assign the residual p to the pi role.

Why valid: It is perpendicular to the sigma plane and can overlap laterally with a suitable neighbour.

Result: Three sigma hybrids + one residual perpendicular p.

4 Check against sp and sp^3 allocations.

Why valid: Those alternatives account for two hybrids plus two p, or four hybrids plus zero p.

Result: All totals are four; no function is simultaneously a hybrid input and an extra residual p.

Stage 1: Lewis Domain Co

$:\ddot{\text{O}} = \text{C} = \ddot{\text{O}}:$ → 2 Electron Do

Double bond = 1 domain; Linea

Lewis domain count

Stage 1 of 4

Model linear sp hybridisation and orthogonal unhybridised p orbital overlap in CO₂.

Worked explanation

Build an allocation ledger for sp, sp², sp³ and flag any duplicate-use entry.

Follow the operation, its justification and its result.

1. For second-period carbon, one 2s and three 2p functions form a four-dimensional valence basis.
2. All totals four; residual p counts 2,1,0.
3. sp² accounting is three hybrid orbitals plus one residual p. A p function already mixed into a hybrid is not simultaneously counted as an additional residual orbital.

Result

All totals four; residual p counts 2,1,0.

Check

Changed check: sp accounting gives two hybrids plus two residual p; sp³ gives four hybrids plus zero residual p.

1-2-3 QUICK CHECK

1 • CHECK

Changed check: sp accounting gives two hybrids plus two residual p; sp³ gives four hybrids plus zero residual p.

2 • APPLY

Allocate the sp² basis without memorising an orbital picture.

3 • CONNECT

For second-period carbon, one 2s and three 2p functions form a four-dimensional valence basis.

Question-specific diagnosis and repair

+

Now you do one

For H-C≡C-H, inventory domains and residual p functions at each C, then count sigma and pi components in the entire molecule. Close the valence-electron ledger.

Practice this concept in Core2

Q2

Q3

Q4

Q7

Q9

